

ThrottleUp

VIN-scan motorcycle maintenance tracker with live NHTSA recall alerts and multi-bike support.

What it is

ThrottleUp is an iOS + Android app for motorcycle maintenance tracking. The VIN scanner pulls make / model / year / engine class live from NHTSA vPIC. Recall integration runs against the NHTSA Recalls API. Service intervals are set per bike (mileage + time based), push reminders fire 30 / 7 / 1 day before due. Multi-bike for the 2+-bike garage. Plus: maintenance log with photo attachments, PDF / CSV export, and anonymous public trip-sharing with privacy-cropped routes.

Who it is for

Wrenchers, project-bike owners, custom builders, daily-driver tuners. Audience skews 20-55, ~95% male, deep European motorcycle community plus US restomod scene. Creator archetypes that convert well: ADV / touring vloggers (Itchy Boots-style global moto travel), garage-vlog channels, build-thread Instagram accounts, cafe-racer / custom-builder creators, oil-change tutorial makers, MotoVloggers, multi-bike garage owners. The audience values authenticity over polish - they detect performative content instantly.

Key features

- VIN scanner: make / model / year / engine class pulled live from NHTSA vPIC database (no manual entry).
- Recall integration: live lookup against NHTSA Recalls API, push notification when a recall drops for a registered bike.
- Service interval reminders: per-bike, mileage + time based, push 30 / 7 / 1 day before due.
- Maintenance log with photo attachments: vendor receipt + install photo per entry.
- Multi-bike management (Premium): unlimited bikes + larger riding groups.
- PDF / CSV export: complete maintenance documentation, useful at resale as proof of care.

Business model

- Single revenue stream: recurring Premium subscription.
- Free tier deliberately generous: 1 bike, 1 riding group up to 4 members, unlimited entries, VIN decode, recall lookup, PDF / CSV export.
- Premium unlocks: unlimited bikes, larger / more riding groups.
- Strategy: Free generous so every rider gets in. Premium is for multi-bike garages, not artificial limits.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates, no posting obligation.

Pricing

- 3.99 USD / month.
- 24.99 USD / year (~ half off vs monthly).
- iOS-first; Android relaunches once the RC Android key is set. Affiliate share is always 50% of the then-current price.

Market gap - what was missing

The motorcycle-maintenance app market is genuinely empty. RIDEOLGY (Kawasaki's official app, the biggest brand-name option) sits at 2.2 stars on the App Store. "Motorcycle Maintenance Log" - the only competing dedicated app - has 1,900 downloads total according to App Annie/Sensor Tower estimates. Most riders track maintenance in a Word doc, a notebook in the garage, or not at all. That's not a market with weak competition - that's a market without competition. The reason is structural: motorcycle is a small audience by total population, riders are notoriously skeptical of digital tools, and the existing players (TCXX, Bike Tracker) shipped clunky 2018-era UX and never updated. ThrottleUp's VIN scan + live NHTSA recall integration is genuinely a category-of-one feature - no competing app pulls live recall data from NHTSA for the user's specific bike.

Why now

Two structural shifts make ThrottleUp possible in 2026. First, NHTSA opened its vPIC and Recalls APIs for free public use, which means we can pull authoritative VIN decode and recall data without a paid data vendor - that wasn't available 5 years ago at this quality level. Second, the moto demographic has finally fully adopted smartphones for garage work (vs print-out maintenance schedules), and the Reddit r/motorcycles + r/ADVRider communities have normalised digital maintenance logs as proof-of-care at resale. The market is ready, the data infrastructure is free, the incumbent is asleep - that's a rare combination.

Affiliate compensation

- 50% of net Premium subscription revenue for 24 months from each attributed user's first paid month.
- 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable (Apple / Google refund window).
- 50 EUR minimum payout, monthly, via Wise.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates (no posting obligation).
- Per-handle dashboard with live click / install / sub / earning split, no agency layer.

How tracking works - DIY attribution stack

Most affiliate stacks ride on top of Branch.io, AppsFlyer or a similar paid attribution SDK. We built our own. Those tools charge per attributed install, they add a third party to the user's first-launch experience, and they make influencer payouts opaque. Moto audiences in particular are skeptical of tracking - every extra SDK is something a wrencher could screenshot and post about. Here is what runs in each stage.

Why we built our own instead of Branch.io

Three reasons. (1) Cost: paid SDKs absorb 8-12% of the affiliate payout pool. (2) Privacy: moto audiences are above-average skeptical of trackers; we read first-launch context as little as possible by design. (3) Transparency: when a dashboard number looks wrong, we read our own code in 10 minutes instead of debugging a vendor black box. The trade-off is we own the bugs. Every line is in our repo.

Android: Google Play install-referrer

Android attribution via Play Install Referrer API is implemented and tested, but Android is currently paused for ThrottleUp pending an Android RC key setup. The deterministic install-referrer path will activate as soon as that's resolved. Your link still works for Android users - they hit a landing page explaining the iOS-first status and a waitlist signup, and attribution applies retroactively when Android relaunches.

iOS warm (app already installed)

If the user already has ThrottleUp installed, iOS routes the tap through a Universal Link directly into the app with the handle in the URL path. We register ``throttleup.app/i/*`` as a Universal Link, Apple's CDN serves the ``apple-app-site-association`` JSON, the OS routes the tap. Deep-link handler reads the URL, extracts the handle, writes the attribution row.

iOS cold (~99% of creator traffic)

The hard case - and ~99% of creator traffic since we're iOS-first - is iOS cold install. iOS gives the freshly installed app no context about how it was reached. Branch.io solves this with device-fingerprinting heuristics that became unreliable after iOS 14.5. We do it differently. When a user taps your link in Safari, our redirect chain hits `throttleup.app/i/[handle]`. That page writes a short-lived JSON token to the clipboard (handle, timestamp, app-key, HMAC-SHA256 signature) before redirecting to the App Store. After install, on first launch, the app reads the clipboard once, parses the JSON, verifies the signature, accepts the token if fresh and signed, and writes the attribution row.

Optional first-open confirmer

Optional fallback. On first open, after we've read whatever the clipboard provided, the app can show a single confirmation: "Invited by @[suggested-handle]? Yes / No". Pre-filled with the clipboard suggestion. ThrottleUp currently runs the confirmer ON because the moto audience is small enough that every attributed install matters, and explicit confirmation catches the edge cases where clipboard access was denied or the user copied content between tap and install.

RevenueCat webhook -> payout queue

Premium purchases flow through RevenueCat. RC handles Apple StoreKit receipts, dedup, refund detection. When ``INITIAL_PURCHASE``, ``RENEWAL``, ``PRODUCT_CHANGE``, or ``CANCELLATION`` fires, RC posts JSON to our Supabase Edge function ``affiliate-rc-webhook``. The function: (1) verifies RC signature, (2) idempotency-checks, (3) looks up the user's attribution row, (4) computes 50% of net after Apple's cut, (5) credits ``affiliate_earnings`` with handle, app, gross, cut, net, our-share, holdback-until, source event ID.

Holdback -> batch -> Wise

Each credited earning enters a 30-day refund holdback. After holdback expires the row flips to ``claimable``. A `pg_cron` job runs ``build_payout_batch()`` on the 5th of each month: groups claimable rows per affiliate, applies the 50 EUR minimum, creates a batch per qualifying affiliate, enqueues to ``wise_dispatch_queue``. `wise-dispatch` calls Wise's v3 transfer API with the affiliate's stored Wise recipient ID. Moto audiences tend to commit to annual subs more often than monthly (riders prefer set-and-forget for tools), which means batches are typically smaller in count but higher in per-row value.

What you see on your dashboard

Your dashboard at getklar.org/dashboard shows the funnel transparently: clicks per day/week/month, install split (iOS warm / iOS cold; Android paused indicator), active Premium subs in your bucket, claimable USD, paid USD, refund-holdback pipeline as a time-series, next payout date, per-app earnings funnel. If a number looks wrong, message us and we can show you the exact webhook payload.

Why this works as an affiliate pitch

The market is empty. RIDEOLGY has 2.2 stars, the existing alternatives are dead. Most riders track in a Word doc or not at all. ThrottleUp's VIN scan + live NHTSA recall layer is genuinely a category-of-one feature. The audience (wrenchers + ADV riders) values tools and trusts other riders, so affiliate conversion is high when the creator is authentic - and very low when they are not.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).